Team 13 — Night's Watch

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Scope check: Well scoped. Eight questions are feasible for three people if you build the inspection-level and violation tables first and confirm early that closures can be matched to reopenings.

Summary

You will use NYC's restaurant inspection results to ask what an "A" grade really tells a diner: how first-inspection scores are distributed (they bunch just under the A cutoff), how grades vary by place and cuisine, whether chains are consistent, which violations drive scores, where pests show up, what happens at re-inspection, and what happens when restaurants are closed.

What's working

- A good fit for an InfoVis class: a topic with clear appeal to most audiences, and no major issues with the problem statement.
- A surprising, concrete hook from the data (4,784 inspections at a score of 13 versus 215 at 14).
- Thorough data understanding: one row per violation, repeated scores, placeholder dates, the need for inspection and violation tables, and the 2010 neighborhood codes for the map.
- A good progression and a clear framing: you are not ranking restaurants or blaming inspectors.
- Clear AI-use disclosure.

Please think through the points in the first section before Milestone 2. How you handle them is your choice; we ask only that you explain your decision in your submission. The visualization suggestions are examples; another design is welcome if you explain how it answers the question.

Points to think through before Milestone 2

1. **Rebuild the cutoff counts at the inspection level.** Since the score repeats on every violation row, reproduce the 13-versus-14 counts from the inspection table, restricted to first inspections, and report which inspection types you included.
2. **Check closure and reopening matching early.** Q8 depends on matching each closure to its reopening. Confirm with a small sample that the records support this, and scope Q8 down if they do not.
3. **Check how grades and the retained data are documented.** Verify in the NYC documentation when a grade is assigned or pending, and what the file keeps (currently open restaurants, roughly three years). Say how you treat missing or pending grades in Q2 and what the retention rule means for Q7 and Q8.

Recommended design direction

- **Choose two or three interactive centerpieces.** The score histogram with the A cutoff, the neighborhood map, and the first-score-to-final-grade flow look natural; keep the others simpler.
- **Describe the cutoff pattern without explaining it.** The bunching below 14 is striking, but this data alone doesn't show why. Present what the data show and cite the research you mention.

- **Show sample sizes** for cuisines and chains with few inspections (Q3, Q4), for example by showing counts or a minimum.

Optional extension

None needed.

Milestone 2 (Nov 2)

You choose which views to sketch first and which data to show. We suggest starting where you are least sure the data can support the question: the inspection-level counts and the closure and reopening matching. For the full submission, map every retained question to its processed data and a sketch; shared tables and views are fine if you show which questions they support. A reader should be able to identify the unit of observation, measures, transformation, comparison, and intended interaction from your sample and sketch. Also check that labels are readable, comparisons use consistent scales, missing data is shown explicitly, and categories can be distinguished without relying only on color.

Milestones

Dates and deliverables from the course slides.

Milestone	Due	Deliverable
1. Proposal	Oct 19	Done
2. Data analysis & sketches	Nov 2	Data tables (a sample of processed data) and a visualization sketch for each question
3. First draft	Nov 16	Notebook with working D3 visualizations for each question
4. Second draft	Nov 30	Complete article: title, introduction, data, questions and findings, conclusion
5. Final submission	Dec 7	Final notebook, code repository with documentation, team contribution statement
Presentation	Dec 11	10 minutes + Q&A

Additional instructions from us

- **GitHub:** create a repository now and send us the link with your Milestone 2 submission (Nov 2). Private is fine; share it with GitHub users `ctsilva` and `kimryan0416`. The final repository should be documented so others can run it.
- **Observable:** *if you are using an Observable notebook for your project*, please make it either public or unlisted and add it as a URL inside the `README.md` of your GitHub project. The final notebook should run without any problems for others who access the notebook.
- **Data access:** list a URL or access steps for every dataset.
- **AI use: include the AI-use statement required by course policy (even if it says none).**